

Tips on Buying Internet-ready Mobile Phones

Do you want a phone that connects to the Internet but are not sure which technology to bet on? If you are confused between the 2G and 3G models, read on to get all the latest on how to enjoy Internet browsing on mobile phones

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As you might be aware, India is amongst the fastest growing mobile phone markets in the world. With the development in technology, mobile phones are being used for voice as well as data applications. Many operators and service providers believe that mobile phones will become the primary medium to access information on the Internet, replacing laptops and PCs.

Access to e-mail and news updates are common reasons that drive demand for Internet access on mobile phones. "Apart from these, there are certain other applications that have gained popularity, such as social net-

working websites like Facebook and Orkut. Also, messenger services (of Yahoo, Gtalk, AIM, etc) will soon replace the SMS services," shares Naved Choudhary, head-marketing, Intex Technologies. Internet is the medium for seeking all kinds of information whether related to the stock market, cricket match scores or even movie schedules.

Do you have the bandwidth?

Lots of mobile phone applications based on the Internet demand good download speeds. The speed and data rates are critical in applications like video streaming, audio

file downloads and live TV. Speeds provided by 2G are good for e-mails or small data transfer applications. But applications like video streaming or live TV require a high bandwidth and higher download speeds.

The pleasure of accessing the Internet on a mobile can only be felt with high speed. "Once you have 3G speed on your mobile, which is about 3.6 MBps downlink, you can watch a video on the move. This happens by using the Internet as the backbone. The video file resides on the server, to which you can connect using 3G connectivity, and view a video online just like you would see it on a TV monitor or LAN," explains Vikas Jain, business director, Micromax.

Internet applications in healthcare, education, employment and information-sharing have changed the value of the system. Online searches, games, music downloads



Nokia N97 mobile phone